ACTORS IN INTERNATIONAL SYSTEM

Actors in the theatrical sense, mean the lead roles in any play or movie. Different actors play different roles on stage or a film. If this concept is transferred to the realm of international system, then the whole international system becomes an arena of dramatic politics where lead roles are played by several actors who may be individuals, groups or organizations. Here, actors are on the one-hand states personified and on the other several non-state actors. Therefore, as Frankel says that conceiving international society as a system and its major components, the states as well as non-state actors, as subsystems, it is possible to conceptualize the reality of world politics in a sensible way. The reality is about influencing and getting influenced. The question here arises who influences and who gets influenced? The answer obviously can be found out by analysing the behavioural patterns of the actors of the international system. The dominant actors always are in an advantageous position and do possess the capabilities to influence and manipulate the behaviour of not so powerful actors. Bargaining and leveraging are the core processes through which the actors try to extend their influence on each other in the international system, although force does retain its importance even in the present time.